



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- b) How does Claude Lévi-Strauss's structuralist approach to mythology reveal the universal structures of the human mind? Provide examples from different cultures to illustrate your answer. (15 marks)

Claude-Lévi Strauss used his structural approach that is the idea of Binary opposites in the study of myths.

Brief on Strauss's Structuralism

- As per Strauss, social structure is a result of pre-programmed code of the human mind.
- he says that human mind thinks in the form of Binary opposites and this opposite is reflected in every aspect of culture.
- He suggests that culture is just like language a means of communication whose rules we know but cannot articulate.

→ For Levi-Strauss, anthropology is not a science of culture but a cognitive science to discover underlying structures of human mind.

Structural analysis of mythology → revealing universal structure of human mind

→ Levi-Strauss says in 'Mythologique' suggests that all myths have a common structure i.e. the presence of binary opposites.

→ He suggests that all myths can be converted to ~~any~~ every other myth by applying certain binary operations on mythemes i.e. smallest component of myth.

→ He studied 800 myths including myths like Asdiwal, Oedipus complex, etc.

→ Based on this, he concludes that since myths are product of human mind, the common foundational structure of all myths reflect the common universal thinking pattern of human mind i.e. to think in Binary opposites.

